

Ray Zhao

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EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF AUCKLAND

Bachelor of Science - Major in Computer Science

Auckland, NZ

Mar 2023 - Nov 2025 (**Graduated**)

Relevant Coursework: Applied Algorithms, Large-Scale Software Development; Functional Programming; Artificial Intelligence

WORK EXPERIENCE

CARUSO — AI-native fund admin services and software, purpose-built for private markets

Auckland, NZ

Backend Software Engineering Intern (full-stack scope facing customer requirements)

Feb 2026 – May 2026

- Shipped 102 merged PRs across 10+ Go/Typescript microservices (~60% product features, ~40% production fixes), spanning MySQL (migrations), DynamoDB, gRPC (unary + streaming, protobuf lifecycle), and Apollo GraphQL consumed by React/Next.js via internal schema-driven clients
- Optimized a client-facing file bulk-download path from ~2000ms to ~200ms by redesigning concurrent architecture with goroutines. Owned system-level understanding across repositories then delivered fund-administration features and eliminated cross-cutting defects and technical debts (e.g. incorrect notification queue, silent-failing internal resource-allocation system, contract mismatches between services and their backing databases) by tracing end-to-end flows and validated fixes on a dev-deployment
- Partnered with **Product** to clarify private-markets customer requirements, pressure-test edge cases, and align scope across teams; translated ambiguous asks into actionable technical work and coordinated delivery across 10+ repositories.
- Led agentic engineering practices: authored many reusable Claude Code **Skills** (codified workflows, conventions, and checklists) so agents could execute repeatable tasks with full context; used AI-assisted exploration and drafting to produce and refine architecture / system diagrams grounded in protos, services, and real call paths.

WDCC — web development & consulting club

Auckland, NZ

Full Stack Developer (for a student club website - uasc.co.nz)

Mar 2024 – Nov 2025

- Collaborated with a team of 12 to develop a scalable booking and payment system handling over 4000+ registered active users and processing over \$80k NZD in online transactions.
- Architected a modular UI component library covering >70% of the frontend, ensuring visual consistency and high-performance rendering that accelerated feature development.

PROJECTS

STOCK ANALYZER — Algorithmic cli trading tool

Feb 2026 - Present

- Built a Go + gRPC cli that screens **4,000+ nasdaq tickers concurrently** end-to-end via the Yahoo Finance API, with a clean service architecture including ingestion, analytics and delivery and a typical full run < ~4 minutes.
- Added a notification module that emails results as soon as a scan completes (async job completion → mailer) with failure/retry safeguards suitable for cron-style operation.
- Implemented modular architecture, plugin-based custom indicators/strategies and accelerated delivery with **agentic engineering**: maintained reusable AI skills (scaffolding, proto/gRPC conventions and review checklists) and used AI-assisted iteration for refactors and backtesting on ~3 years of historical market data.

COLAB — Large scale fullstack application

Technical Lead | Aug 2025 - Nov 2025

- Led the development team (>80% of PRs) and owned code reviews, enforcing clean code standards while shipping production-grade, web-based trading platform with **user-authentication** and **order/inventory** services.
- Designed bulk-fetch API endpoints that returns 200+ reagent datasets in one HTTP request, reduced API latency by ~60-80% (typically <10 ms)
- Independently migrated the backend hosting on **AWS EC2** (LA → Sydney) using PM2 and SSH hardening. Reduced the end-to-end app latency by ~80%.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Systems: full-stack · distributed · performance-aware · end-to-end tracing

Agentic: Skills-as-code · automation / scripts · architecture diagrams · review loops